Chapter 10

A Hard Area Posting:
Optimum Input and Optimum Output

DURING HER STINT AT THE NCB SHE WAS EXPOSED TO THE DRUG scenario at both the national and international levels. She was working at the national level and also attending a lot of seminars and talks on the problem. She was also interacting with international agencies like Interpol and with the respective country's drug liaison officers (DLOs) and the picture of the narcotics trade and drug abuse became clearer in her mind. Also during that period she was pursuing her doctoral studies on 'The Performance Appraisal System'. With this newer and closer involvement she changed her topic to 'Drug Abuse and Criminality'. She was getting access to the best of teachers, to the best of knowledge and, moreover, to the most authentic documentation. However, she did not get time to write her thesis because she was travelling a lot in the course of her duties and also attending and addressing a lot of meetings and seminars on the subject. Moreover, she was spending a lot of time in courts because of the proceedings of the Wadhwa Commission. But she did manage to collect a lot of material on the subject, which was to be organized and collated at a later and more convenient time.

Meanwhile, the Navjyoti programme was working wonders, and had made an impression internationally for its pioneering work in drug abuse treatment. This programme was honoured by a number of national and international awards, which encouraged the mushrooming of drug victims' treatment centres all over India. The feedback from many of these centres helped in keeping her attention focused on the treatment programme. Although Kiran could not take time off to write her research papers, she did manage to chalk out interview schedules and formulate questionnaires in connection with her research work.

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Kiran's next posting took her to the north-eastern state of Mizoram. In contrast to her tight NCB schedules, here, Kiran had a lot of time on her hands. She, therefore, decided to commence writing her doctoral thesis. She realized that it would be difficult and time consuming to trace the drug abuse-related criminals whom she had come across as DCP (North), and moreover they would not now be as forthcoming with their information when she was no longer in charge of that area. So she wrote to the then IG (Prisons), Delhi, H. P. Kumar, requesting his permission to let her interview the drug addicts (around 250) in Tihar Jail. She was very happy that a police officer was holding that charge and explained how the work she was engaged in was very much related to crime and the police. It would assist greatly in crime prevention if one were aware whether drug abuse was followed by crime or vice versa. On one of her visits to Delhi she visited IG (P) Kumar in his office to follow up on her letter. He did not even ask her to sit down and after some time when she reminded him about